



Ilamparathi is India's 90th Grandmaster



Chennai's A.R. Ilamparathi (16) became India's 90th Grandmaster, securing his final GM norm at the Bijeljina tournament in Bosnia and Herzegovina.

Reacting to his feat, his father Ravikumar said that he felt elated for his son, especially after Ilamparathi failed to achieve the final norm over six tournaments since April this year. "He missed by a whisker in all those tournaments!" he added.

Ravikumar said Ilamparathi could have become a GM earlier had he been able to participate in a lot more tournaments. "I have a younger son, who has epilepsy. So, I wasn't able to accompany Ilamparathi all the time. Till last year, either his coach (GM Shyam Sundar) or I used to accompany him to tournaments abroad. I used to cook for him. Now, he's able to travel on his own. I've taught him how to manage on his own," he said.

Ravikumar mentioned that he spoke with Ilamparathi over the phone. "He said he wants to break the 2600 Elo mark and then become a super GM!"

Ilamparathi achieved his first GM norm at the Ha Noi tournament in Vietnam in December 2023. He scored his second GM norm at the Singapore International Open in 2024, and crossed the 2500 Elo mark at the 2024-25 Rilton Cup.

S. PRASANNA VENKATESAN

INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 The second edition of Kashmir Marathon was flagged off by Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah as 1500 athletes from across the country and abroad took part in the event. Bollywood actor Suniel Shetty was also present at the flagging off event while Abdullah ran a half marathon like he did last year. Several politicians including Nasir Aslam Wani, advisor to the chief minister, and MLA Zadibal Tanvir Sadiq participated in the event. Inspector General of Police, Kashmir Zone, V. K. Birdi was also among those who took part.

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2 Arihant KS of Tamil Nadu and qualifier Anika Dubey of Maharashtra emerged the Under-19 boys' and girls' champions respectively in the sub-junior & junior National squash championships, which concluded at the Indian Squash Academy in Chennai. Top seed Arihant, who displayed dominant form through the competition, beat second seed Yusha Nafees (UP) 11-8, 12-10, 10-12, 11-5. Anika, a two-time U-15 national champion, who skipped the U-17 category to compete in the U-19s, beat statemate Akanksha Gupta 11-5, 11-8, 11-8 in the final.

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